

D&D 3.5e Rods — Comprehensive Implementation Plan

Source: Dungeon Master’s Guide 3.5e, Pages 234–237
Status: Pre-Implementation Planning
Previous Sprint: Ring Implementation (Sprint 3, 91% complete)
Date: May 2026

RODS OVERVIEW

Total Rod Count

- **18 unique non-metamagic rods** from DMG/SRD
- **6 metamagic rod types × 3 power levels = 18 metamagic variants**
- **Grand total: 36 individual rod items** (24 unique rod types)

Price Ranges

Category	Price Range
Cheapest	Metamagic Rod of Enlarge/Extend/Silent, Lesser — 3,000 gp
Mid-Range	Rod of Wonder — 12,000 gp
High-End	Rod of Alertness — 85,000 gp
Most Expensive	Metamagic Rod of Quicken, Greater — 170,000 gp

Rod Physical Properties (General)

- **Length:** 2–3 feet
- **Weight:** ~5 lbs (Rod of Lordly Might: 10 lbs)
- **Material:** Iron or other metal
- **AC:** 9 | **HP:** 10 | **Hardness:** 10 | **Break DC:** 27
- **Equipment Slot:** Held item (MainHand or OffHand) — NOT worn equipment
- **Default Weapon Use:** Most function as light mace or club when used as weapons
- **Charges:** Most rods do NOT have charges (exceptions: Rod of Negation historically, Rod of Flame Extinguishing with 10 renewable charges)
- **Usability:** Anyone can use a rod (no class restriction unless specified)

Rod Special Qualities (Random Generation)

d% Roll	Quality
01	Intelligent rod (cannot have charges)
02-31	Design/inscription hints at function
32-100	No special qualities

COMPLETE ROD CATALOG

Random Generation Table (DMG Table 7-16)

d% (Medium)	d% (Major)	Rod	Market Price
01-07	—	Metamagic, Enlarge, lesser	3,000 gp
08-14	—	Metamagic, Extend, lesser	3,000 gp
15-21	—	Metamagic, Silent, lesser	3,000 gp
22-28	—	Immovable Rod	5,000 gp
29-35	—	Metamagic, Empower, lesser	9,000 gp
36-42	—	Metal and Mineral Detection	10,500 gp
43-53	01-04	Cancellation	11,000 gp
54-57	05-06	Metamagic, Enlarge	11,000 gp
58-61	07-08	Metamagic, Extend	11,000 gp
62-65	09-10	Metamagic, Silent	11,000 gp
66-71	11-14	Wonder	12,000 gp
72-79	15-18	Python	13,000 gp
80-83	—	Metamagic, Maximize, lesser	14,000 gp
84-89	19-21	Flame Extinguishing	15,000 gp
90-97	22-25	Viper	19,000 gp
—	26-30	Enemy Detection	23,500 gp
—	31-36	Metamagic, Enlarge, greater	24,500 gp
—	37-42	Metamagic, Extend, greater	24,500 gp
—	43-48	Metamagic, Silent, greater	24,500 gp
—	49-53	Splendor	25,000 gp

d% (Medium)	d% (Major)	Rod	Market Price
—	54–58	Withering	25,000 gp
98–99	59–64	Metamagic, Empower	32,500 gp
—	65–69	Thunder and Lightning	33,000 gp
100	70–73	Metamagic, Quicken, lesser	35,000 gp
—	74–77	Negation	37,000 gp
—	78–80	Absorption	50,000 gp
—	81–84	Flailing	50,000 gp
—	85–86	Metamagic, Maximize	54,000 gp
—	87–88	Rulership	60,000 gp
—	89–90	Security	61,000 gp
—	91–92	Lordly Might	70,000 gp
—	93–94	Metamagic, Empower, greater	73,000 gp
—	95–96	Metamagic, Quicken	75,500 gp
—	97–98	Alertness	85,000 gp
—	99	Metamagic, Maximize, greater	121,500 gp
—	100	Metamagic, Quicken, greater	170,000 gp

ROD CATEGORIES

Category 1: Metamagic Rods (6 types × 3 levels = 18 variants)

See [metamagic_rods_specification.md](#) for full details.

Type	Lesser (≤ 3 rd)	Normal (≤ 6 th)	Greater (≤ 9 th)
Empower	9,000 gp	32,500 gp	73,000 gp
Enlarge	3,000 gp	11,000 gp	24,500 gp
Extend	3,000 gp	11,000 gp	24,500 gp
Maximize	14,000 gp	54,000 gp	121,500 gp
Quicken	35,000 gp	75,500 gp	170,000 gp
Silent	3,000 gp	11,000 gp	24,500 gp

- **All:** CL 17th, Strong (no school), 3 uses/day
- **Activation:** Use-activated (apply when casting spell)
- **Restriction:** One metamagic rod per spell; can combine with wielder's own metamagic feats
- **Sorcerer Note:** Full-round action still required (same as spontaneous metamagic)

Note: The DMG/SRD includes 6 metamagic rod types (Empower, Enlarge, Extend, Maximize, Quicken, Silent). The "Widen" metamagic rod is NOT in the core DMG — it appears in supplemental material only. We implement the core 6.

Category 2: Combat Rods (5 rods)

Rod of Flailing — 50,000 gp

- **CL:** 9th | **Aura:** Moderate enchantment
- **Activation:** Command word (move action to transform)
- **Effect:** Transforms into +3 dire flail (double weapon, extra attack at -2)
- **Special:** Once/day as free action: +4 deflection AC, +4 resistance to saves for 10 minutes (works even in rod form)
- **Charges:** None
- **Daily Limits:** Defensive ability 1/day; weapon transformation unlimited
- **Crafting:** Craft Rod, Craft Magic Arms and Armor, bless

Rod of the Viper — 19,000 gp

- **CL:** 10th | **Aura:** Moderate necromancy
- **Activation:** Command word
- **Effect:** Functions as +2 heavy mace; head transforms into serpent 1/day for 10 min
- **Special:** While serpent-active, successful strikes poison target: 1d10 Con damage immediately + 1d10 Con damage 1 min later (Fort DC 14 negates each)
- **Restriction:** Only functions for evil wielders
- **Daily Limits:** Serpent transformation 1/day
- **Crafting:** Craft Rod, Craft Magic Arms and Armor, poison; creator must be evil

Rod of Python — 13,000 gp

- **CL:** 10th | **Aura:** Moderate transmutation
- **Activation:** Command word (standard action)

- **Effect:** Transforms into constrictor snake (3/day, 10 min each) or giant constrictor (1/week, 10 min)
- **Snake Stats (Constrictor):** HD 3d8+6, HP 19, Attack +5 melee (1d3+4 + grab), Constrict 1d3+4
- **Special:** Snake obeys wielder's telepathic commands; if killed → rod form, unusable 24 hrs
- **Daily Limits:** Constrictor 3/day, Giant Constrictor 1/week
- **Crafting:** Craft Rod, animate objects, polymorph

Rod of Cancellation — 11,000 gp

- **CL:** 17th | **Aura:** Strong abjuration
- **Activation:** Touch (melee touch attack)
- **Effect:** Drains ALL magical properties from touched item
- **Special:** Target item makes DC 23 Will save (or holder's Will if better); rod becomes brittle and useless after one use; drained items only restored by wish/miracle
- **Charges:** ONE USE ONLY — rod is destroyed after use
- **Crafting:** Craft Rod, Mordenkainen's disjunction

Rod of Withering — 25,000 gp

- **CL:** 13th | **Aura:** Strong necromancy
- **Activation:** Touch attack (melee touch)
- **Effect:** Functions as +1 light mace; deals no HP damage, instead deals 1d4 Strength damage + 1d4 Constitution damage on successful touch attack
- **Daily Limits:** None specified (unlimited touch attacks per RAW)
- **Crafting:** Craft Rod, contagion

Category 3: Utility Rods (10 rods)

Immovable Rod — 5,000 gp

- **CL:** 10th | **Aura:** Moderate transmutation
- **Activation:** Button press (move action)
- **Effect:** Rod becomes fixed in space, defying gravity
- **Special:** Supports up to 8,000 lbs before falling; DC 30 Strength check to move 10 ft in 1 round; deactivate by pressing button again
- **Uses:** Unlimited
- **Crafting:** Craft Rod, levitate

Rod of Alertness — 85,000 gp

- **CL:** 11th | **Aura:** Moderate abjuration, divination, enchantment, evocation
- **Activation:** Multiple (passive + standard action for active abilities)
- **Passive:** Functions as +1 light mace; +1 insight bonus on initiative checks
- **At-Will Abilities (standard action each):** detect evil, detect good, detect chaos, detect law, detect magic, discern lies, light, see invisibility
- **Alertness Mode (1/day, standard action):** Plant in ground → detects hostile creatures within 120 ft, 8 flanges each cast light (60 ft range), prayer on allies within 20 ft, mental warning to wielder; lasts 10 minutes
- **Animate Objects (1/day):** Animates up to 8 Small objects within 5 ft radius for 11 rounds
- **Crafting:** Craft Rod, alarm, detect chaos/evil/good/law/magic, discern lies, light, see invisibility, prayer, animate objects

Rod of Enemy Detection — 23,500 gp

- **CL:** 10th | **Aura:** Moderate divination
- **Activation:** Standard action
- **Effect:** Pulses and points toward nearest hostile creature within 60 ft; detects invisible, ethereal, hidden, disguised enemies; full-round concentration pinpoints nearest + indicates total count
- **Daily Limits:** 3/day, each use up to 10 minutes
- **Crafting:** Craft Rod, true seeing

Rod of Flame Extinguishing — 15,000 gp

- **CL:** 12th | **Aura:** Strong transmutation
- **Activation:** Standard action (touch)
- **Charge-Based Effects:**
- **Free:** Extinguish Medium or smaller nonmagical fire with touch
- **1 charge:** Extinguish Large+ nonmagical fire, or Medium/smaller magic fire; suppresses continuous magic flames 6 rounds; counter instantaneous fire spells (readied action)
- **2 charges:** Extinguish Large+ magical fire (e.g., fireball, wall of fire)
- **3 charges:** Deal 6d6 damage to fire creature (melee touch attack)
- **Charges:** 10, renewed daily (up to 10/day)
- **Crafting:** Craft Rod, pyrotechnics

Rod of Metal and Mineral Detection — 10,500 gp

- **CL:** 9th | **Aura:** Moderate divination
- **Activation:** Full-round action (concentration)
- **Effect:** Pulses and points to largest mass of metal within 30 ft; can focus on specific metal/mineral to find location and approximate quantity
- **Uses:** Unlimited
- **Crafting:** Craft Rod, locate object

Rod of Negation — 37,000 gp

- **CL:** 15th | **Aura:** Strong varied
- **Activation:** Standard action (ranged touch attack — ray)
- **Effect:** Negates spell/spell-like functions of magic items; functions like greater dispel magic against item's magical properties; cannot negate artifacts
- **Special:** For instantaneous effects, must ready action; no saving throw for target item
- **Daily Limits:** 3/day
- **Crafting:** Craft Rod, dispel magic, limited wish or miracle

Rod of Rulership — 60,000 gp

- **CL:** 20th | **Aura:** Strong enchantment
- **Activation:** Standard action
- **Effect:** Command obedience/fealty from creatures within 120 ft; affects up to 300 HD of creatures; Int 12+ gets Will DC 16 save
- **Special:** Creatures obey as absolute sovereign; magic breaks if command contradicts nature; rod crumbles after 500 minutes total use (non-continuous)
- **Crafting:** Craft Rod, mass charm monster

Rod of Security — 61,000 gp

- **CL:** 20th | **Aura:** Strong conjuration

- **Activation:** Standard action
- **Effect:** Creates nondimensional safe space for wielder + up to 199 other creatures; natural healing at 5× normal rate
- **Duration:** 200 person-days total (200 days ÷ number of creatures); non-continuous; rod becomes nonmagical when used up
- **Crafting:** Craft Rod, gate

Rod of Splendor — 25,000 gp

- **CL:** 12th | **Aura:** Strong conjuration, transmutation
- **Passive:** +4 enhancement bonus to Charisma while held/carried
- **Active Abilities:**
- **Apparel (1/day):** Creates finest clothing (7,000–10,000 gp apparent value), lasts 12 hours; vanishes if sold/given away/used as components
- **Palatial Tent (1/week):** Creates 60 ft silk pavilion with furnishings and food for 100 people, lasts 1 day
- **Crafting:** Craft Rod, eagle's splendor, fabricate, major creation

Rod of Thunder and Lightning — 33,000 gp

- **CL:** 9th | **Aura:** Moderate evocation
- **Base:** Functions as +2 light mace
- **Five Abilities:**
 1. **Thunder (1/day):** Free action — next strike is +3 light mace, stuns opponent (Fort DC 13 negates)
 2. **Lightning (1/day):** Free action — next strike deals normal +2 damage + 2d6 electricity (touch attack if normal miss)
 3. **Thunderclap (1/day):** Standard action — 2d6 sonic damage, deafens 2d6 rounds (DC 14)
 4. **Lightning Stroke (1/day):** Standard action — 5 ft wide lightning bolt, 9d6 damage, 200 ft range (Reflex DC 14 half)
 5. **Thunder & Lightning Combined (1/week):** Standard action — thunderclap + forked lightning bolt; 9d6 lightning (1s and 2s count as 3s) + 2d6 sonic; single Reflex DC 14 for half of both + deafness
- **Crafting:** Craft Rod, Craft Magic Arms and Armor, lightning bolt, shout

Category 4: Legendary/Complex Rods (2 rods)

Rod of Absorption — 50,000 gp

- **CL:** 15th | **Aura:** Strong abjuration
- **Activation:** Readied action (passive absorption)
- **Effect:** Draws single-target spells and ray-based spell-like abilities directed at wielder, nullifying effect and storing spell levels
- **Storage:** Maximum 50 spell levels; cannot be recharged
- **Conversion:** Wielder converts stored levels to cast prepared spells without expending preparation (bards/sorcerers: cast known spells of appropriate level)
- **New Rod Status:** Roll d% ÷ 2 for remaining absorption capacity; roll d% again — on 71–100, half the absorbed levels are still stored from previous use
- **Crafting:** Craft Rod, spell turning

Rod of Lordly Might — 70,000 gp

- **CL:** 19th | **Aura:** Strong enchantment, evocation, necromancy, transmutation

- **Physical:** Thick metal rod, flanged ball at one end, six buttons, weighs 10 lbs
- **Spell-Like Functions (1/day each):**
 1. Hold person on touch — Will DC 14 negates (melee touch attack)
 2. Fear — all enemies within 10 ft, Will DC 16 partial
 3. Deal 2d4 HP damage on touch + heal wielder same amount — Will DC 17 half (melee touch attack)
- **Weapon Forms (unlimited switching):**
 1. **Default:** +2 light mace
 2. **Button 1:** +1 flaming longsword (4 ft)
 3. **Button 2:** +4 battleaxe (4 ft)
 4. **Button 3:** +3 shortspear or +3 longspear (6–15 ft; lance at 15 ft)
- **Utility Functions (unlimited):**
 - **Button 4:** Climbing pole — spike + 3 hooks, extends 5–50 ft, fold-out horizontal bars; supports 4,000 lbs
 - **Button 5:** Retract climbing pole
 - **Button 6:** Compass — indicates magnetic north, approximate depth/height underground
 - **Door Forcing:** Plant base and extend — Strength modifier +12
 - **Crafting:** Craft Rod, Craft Magic Arms and Armor, inflict light wounds, bull's strength, flame blade, hold person, fear

Category 5: Rod of Wonder (Special — Random Effects)

Rod of Wonder — 12,000 gp

- **CL:** 10th | **Aura:** Moderate enchantment
- **Activation:** Standard action, point at target
- **Range:** 60 ft (varies by effect)
- **Effect:** Roll d100 on the Wondrous Effects table
- **Uses:** Unlimited
- **Crafting:** Craft Rod, confusion; creator must be chaotic

Wondrous Effects Table (d100):

d%	Effect
01-05	Slow creature pointed at for 10 rounds (Will DC 15 negates)
06-10	Faerie fire surrounds the target
11-15	Deludes wielder for 1 round into believing rod functions as indicated by second d% roll (no save)
16-20	Gust of wind at windstorm force (Fort DC 14 negates)
21-25	Wielder learns target's surface thoughts (detect thoughts) for 1d4 rounds (no save)
26-30	Stinking cloud at 30 ft range (Fort DC 15 negates)
31-33	Heavy rain falls for 1 round in 60 ft radius centered on wielder
34-36	Summon animal: rhino (01-25), elephant (26-50), or mouse (51-100)
37-46	Lightning bolt (70 ft long, 5 ft wide), 6d6 damage (Reflex DC 15 half)
47-49	600 large butterflies pour forth for 2 rounds, blind everyone within 25 ft (Reflex DC 14 negates)
50-53	Enlarge person on target within 60 ft (Fort DC 13 negates)
54-58	Darkness, 30 ft diameter hemisphere, centered 30 ft from rod
59-62	Grass grows in 160 sq ft area, or existing grass grows 10× normal
63-65	Turn ethereal any nonliving object up to 1,000 lbs / 30 cu ft
66-69	Reduce wielder to 1/12 height (no save)
70-79	Fireball at target or 100 ft ahead, 6d6 damage (Reflex DC 15 half)

d%	Effect
80-84	Invisibility on rod wielder
85-87	Leaves grow from target within 60 ft, last 24 hours
88-90	10-40 gems (1 gp each) shoot 30 ft stream, 1 dmg each; 5d4 hits divided among targets
91-95	Shimmering colors over 40×30 ft area; blind 1d6 rounds (Fort DC 15 negates)
96-97	Wielder (50%) or target (50%) turns permanently blue, green, or purple (no save)
98-100	Flesh to stone (or stone to flesh if stone) within 60 ft (Fort DC 18 negates)

ROD COMPLEXITY TIERS

See **rods_by_complexity.md** for the full tier classification document.

Summary

Tier	Stars	Description	Rod Count
1	★	Simple/Passive	2
2	★★	Single Active Ability	5
3	★★★	Multi-Use / Metamagic	25
4	★★★★★	Multi-Ability Complex	4

NEW SYSTEMS REQUIRED

SYSTEM 1: Rod Equipment & Activation Framework

Purpose: Rods are held items that must be in-hand to use. Some function as weapons.

Components:

```

public enum EquipSlot
{
    // Existing slots...
    MainHand,
    OffHand,
    // Rods occupy MainHand or OffHand
}

public enum RodActivationType
{
    Passive,           // Always on when held (Alertness initiative bonus, Splendor CHA)
    CommandWord,       // Standard action to activate (Python, Flailing transform)
    UseActivated,       // Apply during another action (Metamagic rods during casting)
    ButtonPress,        // Move action (Immovable Rod)
    TouchAttack,        // Melee touch attack (Cancellation, Withering)
    PointAndActivate    // Standard action, aim at target (Wonder, Enemy Detection)
}

public class RodData
{
    public string RodName;
    public int MarketPrice;
    public int CasterLevel;
    public RodActivationType ActivationType;
    public int Weight = 5; // Default 5 lbs
    public bool FunctionsAsWeapon;
    public string WeaponType; // "LightMace", "HeavyMace", "DireFlail", etc.
    public int WeaponEnhancementBonus;
    public int UsesPerDay = -1; // -1 = unlimited
    public int MaxCharges = -1; // -1 = no charges
    public bool IsEvil; // Alignment restriction (Viper)
}

```

Implementation Notes:

- Rod must be held to activate abilities (check equipment slot)
- Rods that function as weapons use existing weapon attack system
- Some rods transform between rod/weapon forms (move or command action)
- Cannot use two rods simultaneously (one per hand, most require active wielding)

Time: 2-3 days

SYSTEM 2: Metamagic Rod System

Purpose: Apply metamagic feats to spells without increasing slot level.

See **metamagic_rods_specification.md** for complete system design.

```

public enum MetamagicType
{
    Empower,      // Numeric effects +50%
    Enlarge,      // Double range
    Extend,       // Double duration
    Maximize,     // All numeric values maximized
    Quickened,    // Cast as swift action
    Silent        // No verbal component required
}

public enum MetamagicRodTier
{
    Lesser, // Spells ≤ 3rd level
    Normal, // Spells ≤ 6th level
    Greater // Spells ≤ 9th level
}

public class MetamagicRodEffect
{
    public MetamagicType Type;
    public MetamagicRodTier Tier;
    public int MaxSpellLevel; // 3, 6, or 9
    public int UsesPerDay = 3;
    public int UsesToday = 0;

    public bool CanApplyToSpell(int spellLevel)
    {
        return spellLevel <= MaxSpellLevel && UsesToday < UsesPerDay;
    }

    public void ApplyMetamagic()
    {
        UsesToday++;
    }

    public void ResetOnRest()
    {
        UsesToday = 0;
    }
}

```

Integration Points:

- Spell casting UI: show available metamagic options from held rod
- Apply metamagic effect without changing spell slot
- Track daily uses (3/day per rod)
- Sorcerers: still full-round action with metamagic rod
- Cannot combine two metamagic rods on one spell
- CAN combine rod + wielder's own metamagic feat (only feat raises slot)
- Reset uses on long rest

Time: 5–7 days

SYSTEM 3: Rod of Wonder Random Effects Engine

Purpose: Implement the 100-entry random effects table.

```

public class RodOfWonderManager
{
    public struct WonderEffect
    {
        public int MinRoll;
        public int MaxRoll;
        public string EffectName;
        public string Description;
        public Action<Character, Vector2Int> Execute;
    }

    private static List<WonderEffect> _effectTable;

    public static WonderEffect TriggerRandomEffect(Character wielder, Vector2Int target)
    {
        {
            int roll = Random.Range(1, 101); // d100
            var effect = _effectTable.First(e => roll >= e.MinRoll && roll <= e.MaxRoll);
            effect.Execute?.Invoke(wielder, target);
            return effect;
        }
    }
}

```

Effect Categories to Implement:

- **Spell Effects:** Slow, Faerie Fire, Lightning Bolt, Fireball, Enlarge Person, Darkness, Invisibility, Stinking Cloud, Gust of Wind, Flesh to Stone, Detect Thoughts
- **Summoning:** Rhino, Elephant, Mouse
- **Environmental:** Rain, Grass Growth, Shimmering Colors
- **Conjuration:** Butterflies (blind), Gems (damage stream)
- **Transmutation:** Reduce wielder, Leaves on target, Ethereal object, Color change
- **Meta:** Delusion effect (fake result)

Time: 3-4 days

SYSTEM 4: Rod of Absorption — Spell Absorption System

Purpose: Absorb incoming spells and convert stored levels to spell slots.

```

public class RodOfAbsorptionEffect
{
    public int MaxStorageLevels = 50;
    public int CurrentAbsorbed = 0; // Levels absorbed (capacity used)
    public int StoredLevels = 0;    // Levels available for conversion
    public int RemainingCapacity => MaxStorageLevels - CurrentAbsorbed;

    /// <summary>
    /// Attempt to absorb an incoming single-target spell or ray.
    /// Only works on spells targeting the wielder directly.
    /// </summary>
    public bool AbsorbSpell(int spellLevel)
    {
        if (spellLevel > RemainingCapacity)
            return false; // Cannot absorb – rod is full

        CurrentAbsorbed += spellLevel;
        StoredLevels += spellLevel;
        return true; // Spell nullified
    }

    /// <summary>
    /// Convert stored levels to regain a spell slot.
    /// </summary>
    public bool ConvertToSpellSlot(Character wielder, int slotLevel)
    {
        if (StoredLevels < slotLevel)
            return false;

        StoredLevels -= slotLevel;
        // Restore spell slot for prepared casters
        // OR allow known-spell cast for spontaneous casters
        wielder.RestoreSpellSlot(slotLevel);
        return true;
    }

    /// <summary>
    /// Initialize a found rod with random remaining capacity.
    /// </summary>
    public void InitializeFound()
    {
        int capacityPercent = Random.Range(1, 101);
        CurrentAbsorbed = MaxStorageLevels - (capacityPercent / 2);

        int storedRoll = Random.Range(1, 101);
        if (storedRoll >= 71)
            StoredLevels = CurrentAbsorbed / 2;
        else
            StoredLevels = 0;
    }
}

```

Mechanics:

- Readied action to absorb (or auto-absorb on directed spells)
- Only absorbs single-target spells and rays aimed at wielder
- Rod cannot be recharged — once 50 levels absorbed, no more absorption
- Stored levels can be converted to spell slots at any time
- Track both “absorption capacity used” and “stored levels available”

Time: 2–3 days

SYSTEM 5: Multi-Form Rod System (Lordly Might)

Purpose: Rod that transforms between multiple weapon/utility forms.

```
public enum LordlyMightForm
{
    Mace,           // +2 light mace (default)
    FlamingSword,   // +1 flaming longsword
    Battleaxe,      // +4 battleaxe
    Spear,          // +3 shortspear / longspear
    ClimbingPole,   // 5-50 ft pole with rungs
    Compass         // Indicates north / depth / height
}

public class RodOfLordlyMight
{
    public LordlyMightForm CurrentForm = LordlyMightForm.Mace;
    public int HoldPersonUsesToday = 0; // 1/day
    public int FearUsesToday = 0;      // 1/day
    public int DrainHealUsesToday = 0; // 1/day

    public WeaponStats GetCurrentWeaponStats()
    {
        return CurrentForm switch
        {
            LordlyMightForm.Mace => new WeaponStats("Light Mace", +2, "1d6"),
            LordlyMightForm.FlamingSword => new WeaponStats("Longsword", +1, "1d8", fl
aming: true),
            LordlyMightForm.Battleaxe => new WeaponStats("Battleaxe", +4, "1d8"),
            LordlyMightForm.Spear => new WeaponStats("Shortspear", +3, "1d6"),
            _ => null
        };
    }

    public void SwitchForm(LordlyMightForm newForm)
    {
        CurrentForm = newForm;
        // Update weapon stats, UI, etc.
    }
}
```

Complexity:

- 4 weapon forms with different stats
- 2 utility forms (climbing pole, compass)
- 3 spell-like abilities (1/day each)
- Door-forcing mechanic (Str +12)
- Climbing pole supports 4,000 lbs, extends 5-50 ft

Time: 3-4 days

SYSTEM 6: Creature Summoning (Python Rod)

Purpose: Rod transforms into a creature ally.

```

public class SummonedRodCreature
{
    public string CreatureName; // "Constrictor Snake", "Giant Constrictor Snake"
    public int HD;
    public int HP;
    public int AttackBonus;
    public string Damage;
    public bool HasGrab;
    public string ConstrictDamage;
    public int DurationRounds; // 100 (10 minutes)
    public bool IsAlive = true;

    // If killed, rod unusable for 24 hours
    public bool RodDisabledUntilRest = false;
}

```

Time: 2 days

IMPLEMENTATION TIMELINE

PHASE 1: Foundation (1 week)

- [] Rod equipment slot system (MainHand/OffHand)
- [] RodFactory and RodDatabase
- [] RodNames enum (all 36 rod items)
- [] Basic activation framework (command word, button, touch, etc.)
- [] Rod UI panel (show held rod abilities, uses remaining)
- [] Daily use tracking + reset on rest
- [] Save/load rod state

PHASE 2: Simple Rods (1 week)

- [] Immovable Rod (button → fixed in space, 8,000 lb limit, DC 30 to move)
- [] Rod of Metal and Mineral Detection (locate metal within 30 ft)
- [] Rod of Enemy Detection (detect hostiles within 60 ft, 3/day)
- [] Rod of Flame Extinguishing (charge-based fire suppression)
- [] Rod of Splendor (+4 CHA passive, apparel/tent creation)

PHASE 3: Metamagic Rods (2 weeks)

- [] Metamagic application system core
- [] Spell casting UI integration (show metamagic options)
- [] Empower implementation (+50% numeric effects)
- [] Enlarge implementation (double range)
- [] Extend implementation (double duration)
- [] Maximize implementation (max all numeric values)
- [] Quicken implementation (swift action casting)
- [] Silent implementation (remove verbal component)
- [] Lesser/Normal/Greater tier restrictions
- [] Daily use tracking (3/day each rod)
- [] Integration tests: 6 types × 3 tiers = 18 variants

PHASE 4: Combat Rods (1 week)

- [] Rod of Flailing (+3 dire flail, +4 AC/saves 1/day)
- [] Rod of Python (transform to constrictor snake, creature AI)
- [] Rod of the Viper (+2 heavy mace, poison 1/day, evil-only)
- [] Rod of Cancellation (drain magic item, one-use, destroy rod)
- [] Rod of Withering (Str + Con damage on touch)

PHASE 5: Complex Utility Rods (1.5 weeks)

- [] Rod of Wonder (100 random effects table)
- [] Rod of Alertness (passive bonuses + 8 at-will detects + alertness mode + animate)
- [] Rod of Rulership (mass charm, 300 HD, 500 min total)
- [] Rod of Thunder and Lightning (5 distinct abilities)
- [] Rod of Negation (dispel magic items, 3/day)
- [] Rod of Security (nondimensional safe space)

PHASE 6: Legendary Rods (1 week)

- [] Rod of Absorption (absorb spells, store levels, convert to slots)
- [] Rod of Lordly Might (6 forms, 3 spell-likes, door forcing, compass)

Total Estimated Time: 7.5 weeks

DETAILED ROD SPECIFICATIONS — QUICK REFERENCE

All 18 Non-Metamagic Rods (sorted by price)

#	Rod	Price	CL	Activation	Key Mechanic
1	Immovable Rod	5,000	10	Button (move)	Fixed in space, 8,000 lb
2	Rod of Metal & Mineral Detection	10,500	9	Full-round	Detect metal 30 ft
3	Rod of Cancellation	11,000	17	Touch attack	Drain item, one-use
4	Rod of Wonder	12,000	10	Standard	d100 random effect
5	Rod of Python	13,000	10	Command word	Snake ally 3/day
6	Rod of Flame Extinguishing	15,000	12	Standard/touch	10 charges/day, fire suppression
7	Rod of the Viper	19,000	10	Command word	+2 mace, poison 1/day, evil
8	Rod of Enemy Detection	23,500	10	Standard	Detect hostiles 60 ft, 3/day
9	Rod of Splendor	25,000	12	Passive + daily	+4 CHA, apparel, tent
10	Rod of Withering	25,000	13	Touch attack	1d4 STR + 1d4 CON dmg
11	Rod of Thunder & Lightning	33,000	9	Multiple	+2 mace, 5 abilities
12	Rod of Negation	37,000	15	Standard (ray)	Dispel item magic, 3/day
13	Rod of Absorption	50,000	15	Readied	Absorb spells, max 50 levels

#	Rod	Price	CL	Activation	Key Mechanic
14	Rod of Flailing	50,000	9	Command word	+3 dire flail, +4 AC 1/day
15	Rod of Rulership	60,000	20	Standard	Mass charm 300 HD, 500 min
16	Rod of Security	61,000	20	Standard	Safe demiplane, 200 person-days
17	Rod of Lordly Might	70,000	19	Buttons/commands	4 weapons + 3 spell-likes + utility
18	Rod of Alertness	85,000	11	Multiple	+1 mace, +1 init, 8 detects, alertness

PRIORITY MATRIX

See **rods_priority_matrix.md** for the full impact vs. complexity analysis.

Summary — Build Order Recommendation

Priority	Rods	Rationale
P1 — Core	Immovable Rod, Metamagic Rods (all 18)	Iconic items; metamagic is core caster mechanic
P2 — High	Rod of Cancellation, Negation, Flailing, Viper, Withering	Combat utility, relatively straightforward
P3 — Medium	Rod of Wonder, Thunder & Lightning, Python, Enemy Detection	Moderate complexity, high fun factor
P4 — Lower	Alertness, Rulership, Absorption, Lordly Might	Complex multi-ability implementations
P5 — Niche	Security, Splendor, Flame Extinguishing, Metal & Mineral Detection	Situational use, lower combat impact

TESTING PLAN

Per-Rod Standard Tests

- [] Equip rod in MainHand → verify held
- [] Activate each ability → verify effect
- [] Track uses/charges → verify decrement
- [] Rest → verify daily use reset
- [] Save game → load game → verify rod state preserved
- [] Unequip rod → verify abilities deactivate

Metamagic Rod Tests

- [] Wizard casts Fireball with Rod of Empower, Lesser → damage ×1.5
- [] Verify 3rd-level slot consumed (not 5th)
- [] Use count shows 2/3 remaining
- [] Try to use with 4th-level spell + Lesser rod → blocked
- [] Cast 3 spells with metamagic → 0/3 remaining → 4th attempt blocked
- [] Long rest → uses reset to 3/3
- [] Try two metamagic rods on one spell → blocked
- [] Metamagic rod + own feat → rod doesn't raise slot, feat does

Immovable Rod Tests

- [] Press button → rod fixed in space (doesn't fall)
- [] Apply 8,000 lbs force → rod holds
- [] Apply 8,001+ lbs → rod falls
- [] DC 30 Strength check → rod moves 10 ft
- [] Press button again → rod released

Rod of Absorption Tests

- [] Enemy casts single-target spell at wielder → absorbed
- [] Spell levels stored correctly (e.g., Fireball = 3 levels)
- [] Wielder converts 3 stored levels → regains 3rd-level slot
- [] Fill to 50 levels → no more absorption
- [] AoE spell → NOT absorbed (only single-target/ray)

Rod of Wonder Tests

- [] Activate → roll d100 → correct effect triggers
- [] Multiple activations → different rolls/effects
- [] Verify each of the 20 effect categories works
- [] Effects that target wielder work correctly
- [] Save DCs match table values

Rod of Lordly Might Tests

- [] Default form = +2 light mace stats
- [] Button 1 → +1 flaming longsword, fire damage
- [] Button 2 → +4 battleaxe stats

- [] Button 3 → +3 spear stats
- [] Hold person ability (1/day) → touch, Will DC 14
- [] Fear ability (1/day) → 10 ft, Will DC 16
- [] Drain/heal ability (1/day) → 2d4, Will DC 17
- [] Climbing pole extends 5–50 ft
- [] Compass shows north/depth

SUCCESS CRITERIA

Complete when:

- [] All 36 rod items implemented and functional
- [] Rod equipment slot system (held items) operational
- [] Metamagic rod system fully integrated with spell casting
- [] Daily use tracking + rest reset working
- [] Charge tracking working (Flame Extinguishing)
- [] One-use rod destruction (Cancellation)
- [] Limited-use rod depletion (Rulership 500 min, Security 200 days)
- [] Rod of Wonder all 20 effect categories triggering correctly
- [] Rod of Absorption spell absorption + conversion working
- [] Rod of Lordly Might all 6 forms + 3 spell-likes functional
- [] Creature summoning (Python) with basic AI
- [] UI displays rod abilities, uses remaining, charges
- [] Save/load preserves all rod state
- [] All tests pass

ESTIMATED DELIVERABLES

Code Files

1. `RodFactory.cs` — Rod creation and initialization
2. `RodDatabase.cs` — All 36 rod definitions with stats
3. `RodNames.cs` — Enum of all rod names
4. `RodData.cs` — Rod data model (extends `ItemData`)
5. `MetamagicRodManager.cs` — Metamagic application system
6. `MetamagicType.cs` — Metamagic enum and tier definitions
7. `RodOfWonderEffects.cs` — 20 effect implementations + d100 table
8. `RodOfAbsorptionManager.cs` — Spell absorption + conversion
9. `RodOfLordlyMightController.cs` — Multi-form weapon system
10. `RodOfPythonController.cs` — Creature summoning
11. `RodActivationHandler.cs` — Activation type routing
12. Updated `ItemData.cs` — Rod-specific fields
13. Updated `EquipmentManager.cs` — Held item slot logic
14. Updated `SpellCastingUI.cs` — Metamagic rod integration
15. Updated `GameManager.cs` — Rod activation hooks
16. Updated `SaveLoadManager.cs` — Rod state persistence

Documentation

1. `rods_implementation_plan.md` — This document
2. `rods_by_complexity.md` — Tier classification
3. `metamagic_rods_specification.md` — Detailed metamagic mechanics
4. `rods_priority_matrix.md` — Impact vs. complexity analysis